ITM MAHIDOL UNIVERSITY

Module 4

Governance



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Syllabus

4.3 Governance

- 4.3.1 Define governance (5.3.1)
- 4.3.2 Explain the enabling nature and the activities of governance (5.3.1)



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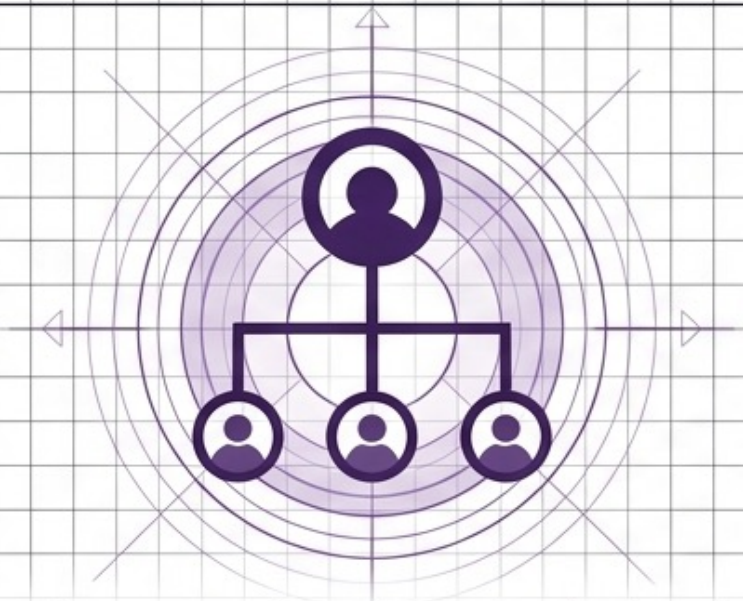
What you will learn

By the end of this module, you will be able to:

- define governance and its role in directing and controlling an organization
- explain the enabling nature of governance and the key activities through which governance supports value co-creation.



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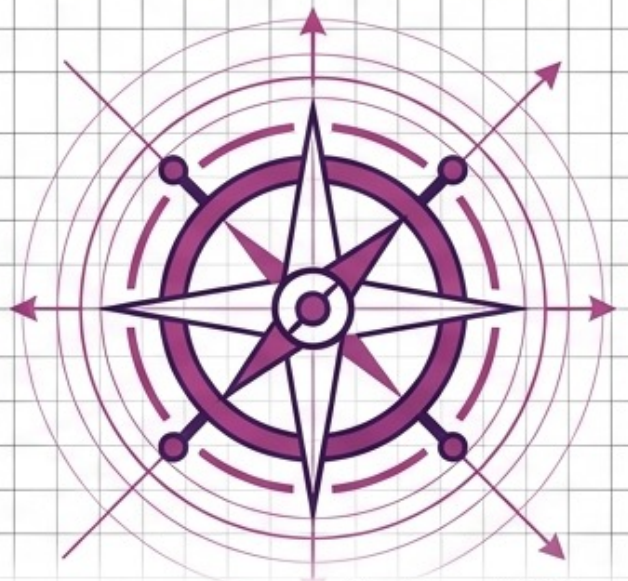


The Governing Body (The Who)

Definition: A person or group of people accountable at the highest level for the performance and compliance of the organization.

Examples: Board of Directors, Executive Managers.

Mandate: Accountable for the organization's compliance with internal policies and external regulations.



Governance (The What)

Definition: The system by which an organization is directed and controlled.

Scope: Applies to all aspects of the organization, fundamentally including the use of digital technology and the digital product and service management system.

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Governing bodies and governance

Governance defines how organizations are directed and controlled, including oversight of digital technology.

Governance
The system by which an organization is directed and controlled.

Governance of digital technology
A human-based system by which the current and future use of digital technology is governed.



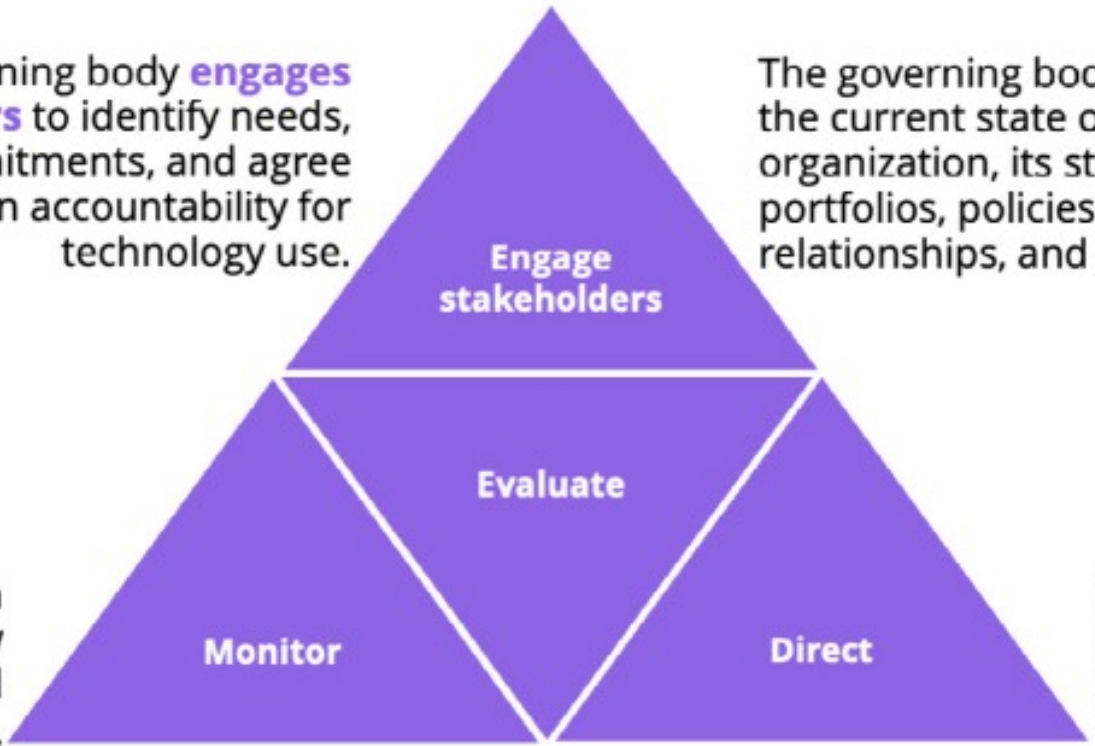
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Governance of digital technology

Digital technology governance is realized through the following activities:

The governing body **engages stakeholders** to identify needs, clarify commitments, and agree on accountability for technology use.

The governing body **evaluates** the current state of the organization, its strategies, portfolios, policies, relationships, and so on.



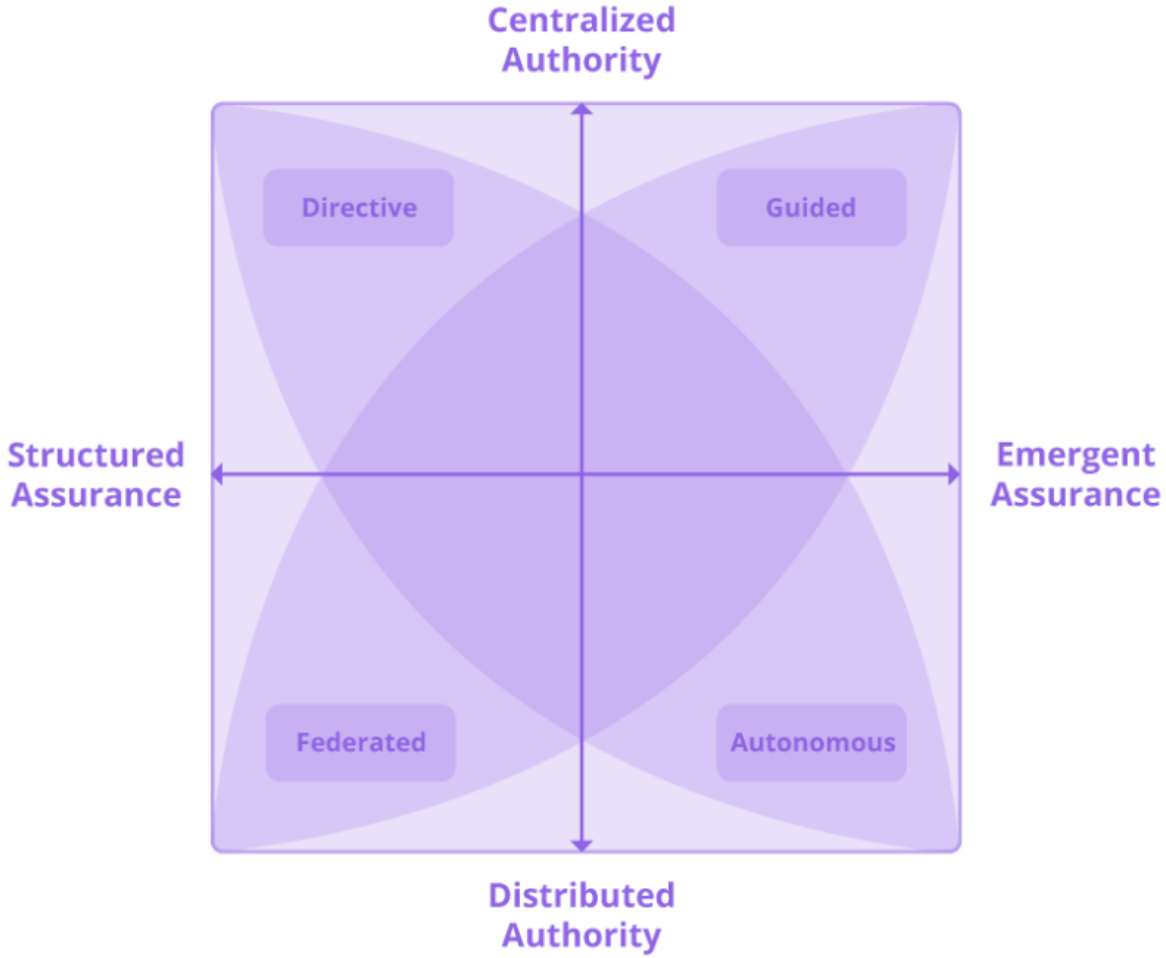
With policies and strategies in place, the governing body now **monitors** performance and compliance.

During **direction,** policies and strategies are established and modified.

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The Four Governance Patterns

Governance is not one-size-fits-all. It is shaped by organizational values, culture, and business context along two primary axes.



Centralized Authority Patterns

Directive

Centralized / Structured

- **Mechanism:** Top-down control executed through formal hierarchies.
- **Execution:** Strict procedures and highly standardized processes.
- **Optimal Use:** Environments requiring maximum predictability, unified compliance, and tight regulatory control.

Guided

Centralized / Emergent

- **Mechanism:** A strong central vision paired with overarching strategic direction.
- **Execution:** Local freedom and autonomy in how the vision is executed and implemented.
- **Optimal Use:** Organizations balancing the need for unified corporate goals with localized agility and creative problem-solving.

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Distributed Authority Patterns

Federated

Distributed / Structured

- **Mechanism:** Multiple distributed units operating with delegated authority.
- **Execution:** Coordination is achieved through formal structures and agreed-upon cross-unit frameworks.
- **Optimal Use:** Large, complex enterprises with distinct business units that still require common operational standards.

Autonomous

Distributed / Emergent

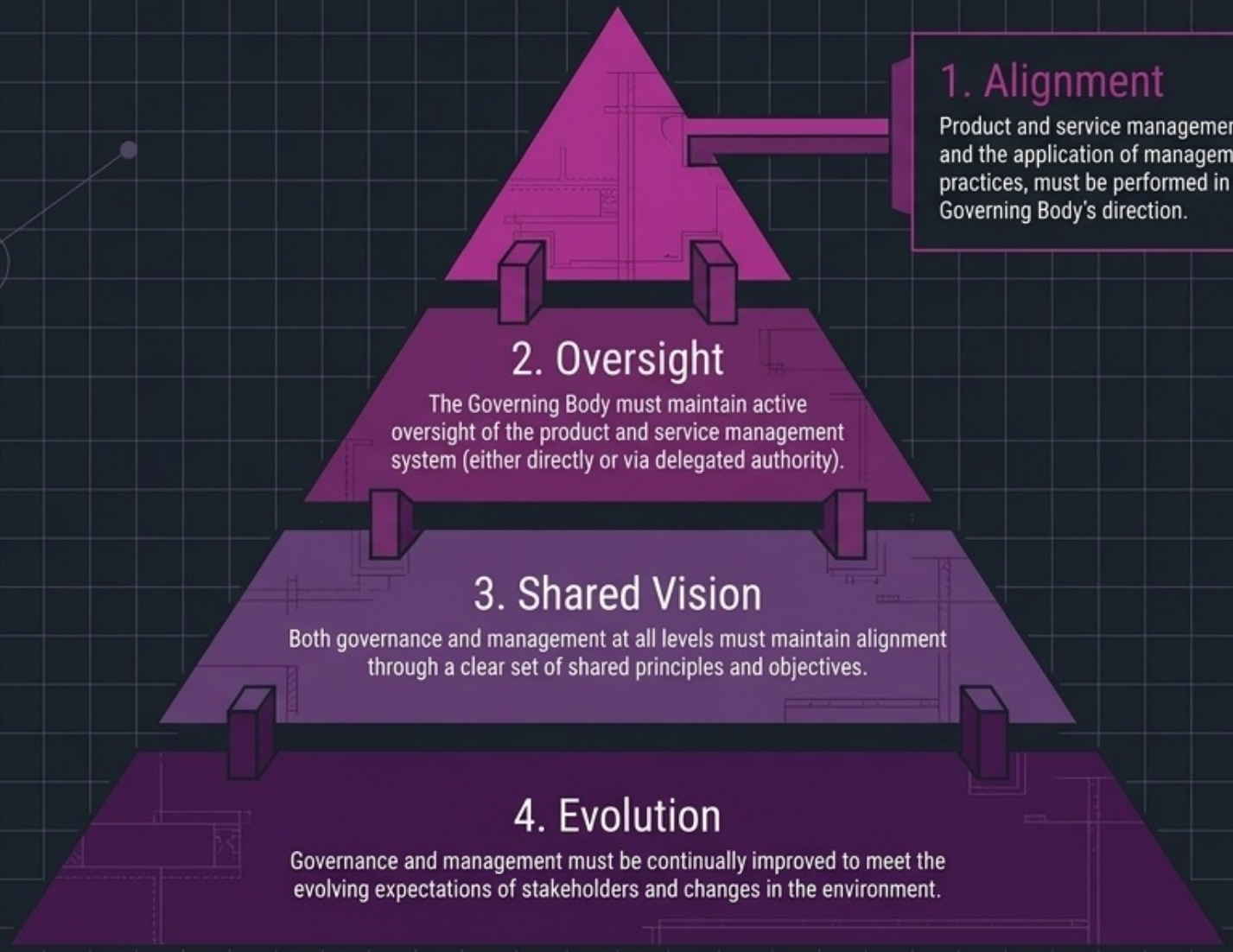
- **Mechanism:** Self-organizing teams capable of making independent, localized decisions.
- **Execution:** System cohesion is achieved through peer collaboration, mutual influence, and a shared culture rather than formal reporting lines.
- **Optimal Use:** Highly innovative, agile environments optimizing for speed, adaptability, and rapid market response.

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Characteristics of governance patterns

	Directive	Guided	Federated	Autonomous
Engage stakeholders	Top-down information flow; stakeholders receive decisions, not consulted.	Leadership storytelling and vision-casting; idea harvesting from below.	Protocol-based engagement per unit; inter-unit coordination forums.	No designated engager; anyone can convene anyone.
Evaluate organization	Performance against predetermined standards; deviation requires justification.	Success redefined as context evolves; leading indicators valued over lagging.	Unit-specific interpretation of enterprise metrics; systematic comparison across units.	No imposed metrics; groups define what matters to them.
Direct organization	Permission required for decisions; escalation for any deviation.	Direction through 'commander's intent'; how is flexible if why is clear.	Documented decision rights matrix; structured escalation paths between units.	No formal directing; influence through expertise not position.
Monitor organization	Compliance verification; variance reports trigger intervention.	Pattern sensing over rule-checking; insights valued over compliance.	Standardized exception handling; portfolio-level integration reviews.	No formal monitoring; peer visibility creates natural accountability.
Typical signals of ineffectiveness	Initiative paralysis without approval; blind spots from filtered information.	Different interpretations of intent cause divergence; vision without execution.	Units optimize locally, suboptimize globally; coordination consumes excessive resources.	Lack of coherent direction; critical dependencies missed; uneven capability development.

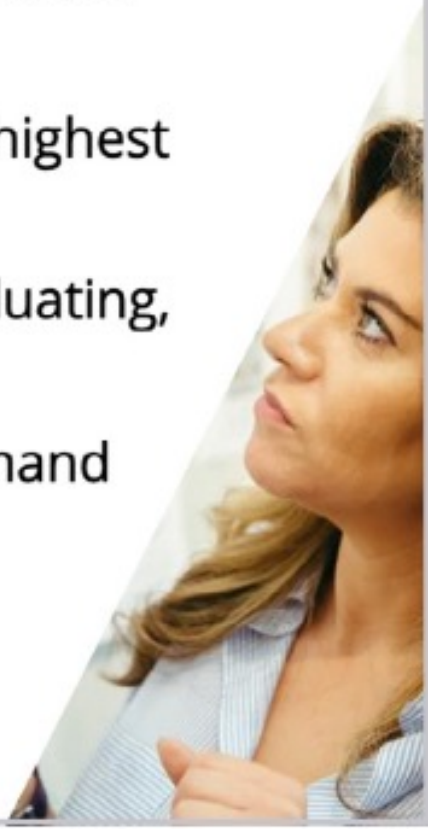
The 4 Imperatives of Effective ITIL Governance



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Recap: Key learning points

- Governance defines how organizations are **directed and controlled**, including oversight of digital technology.
- Governance provides **direction**, **oversight**, and **accountability**, ensuring decisions align with organizational purpose and stakeholder needs.
- The governing body is accountable for **performance and compliance** at the highest level.
- Governance is realized through **activities** such as engaging stakeholders, evaluating, directing, and monitoring.
- The management system ties the components **together** so that inputs of demand and opportunity are transformed into outcomes of value.



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Quiz

Questions:

1. Which governance activity is focused on ensuring adherence with policies and strategic direction?
   A. Evaluate
   B. Direct
   C. Monitor
   D. Discover

2. What is the role of a governing body in an organization?

   A. It is accountable for performance and compliance at the highest level

   B. It is responsible for day-to-day operations

   C. It manages the technical details of digital products directly

   D. It focuses exclusively on financial reporting